Year 1 English - Discussion Skills

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LEARN IT - look, say and notice

Model: An active listener looks toward the speaker, waits for a turn and responds: “I heard your idea. I also think...”

Remember: Listening means showing that you understood, not only staying quiet.

A. TRY IT TOGETHER

1. Circle the listening behaviour: interrupt / wait / look away.

2. Write one question that builds on an idea.

3. Finish: “I agree because...”

B. MY PRACTICE

1. Write a turn-taking phrase.

2. Write a polite disagreement.

3. What can you do if you did not hear?

4. Add one idea to “Books teach us new things.”

5. Name one helpful listening body action.

C. I CAN DO IT

Write a two-person, four-line discussion with balanced turns.

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D. USE IT IN A REAL SITUATION

A group is choosing a class read-aloud. Write one idea, one question and one response to another person.

E. CHECK AND EXPLAIN

1. How can a question help a discussion grow?

2. What is the difference between waiting and active listening?

MY LEARNING REVIEW

☐ I can do it. ☐ I need a little help. ☐ I need more practice.

I understood:

I found this difficult:

PARENT / CARER TIP

During family talk, ask the child to repeat one idea they heard before adding their own.

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COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

Guided	Wait; valid related question; relevant reason.
Practice	Examples: “May I add...?”, “I see it differently because...”, ask for repetition; responses vary.
Independent	Four coherent lines with turn-taking.
Application	Relevant idea, question and response.

TEACHER NOTES - what to notice

Success evidence: Takes turns, speaks clearly, listens actively and responds to contributions.

Common difficulty: Repeating one’s own idea instead of responding to the speaker.

Next step: Use sentence stems to compare, add, question and clarify.

QUICK CONFERENCE RECORD

☐ Secure ☐ Developing ☐ Re-teach

Evidence / next lesson focus: